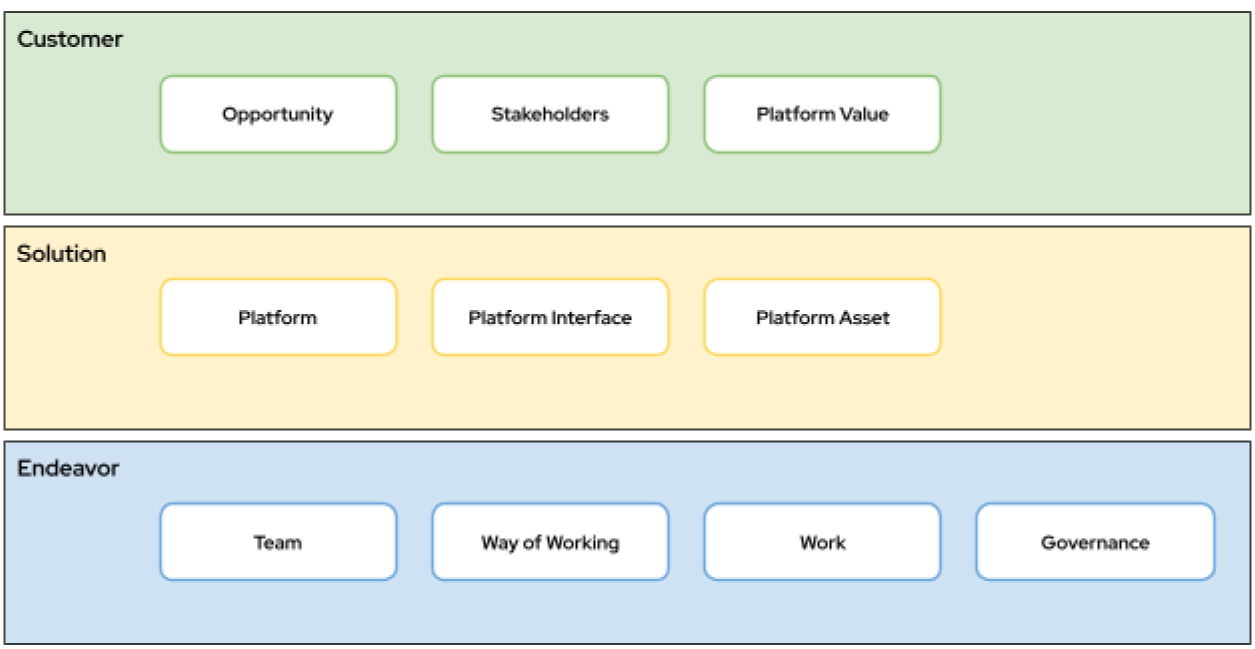
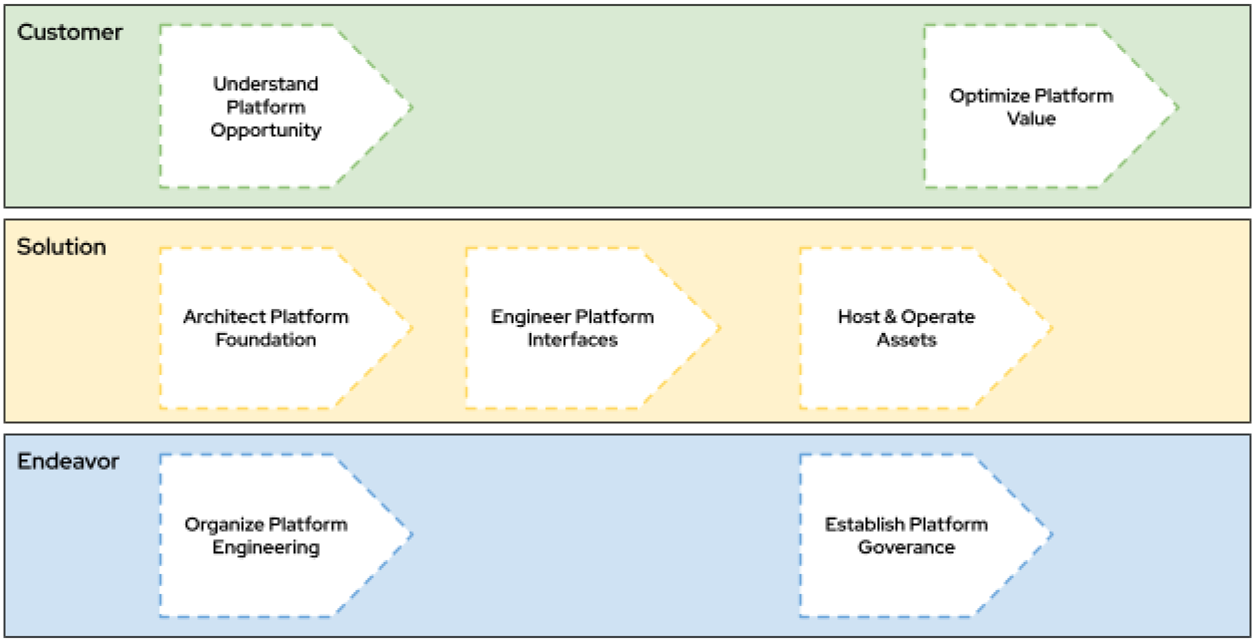
The Platform Adoption Kernel

The Platform Adoption Kernel establishes the universal foundation for platform transformations, organized into the three standard Essence Areas of Concern. It integrates reused standard SE Kernel Alphas alongside domain-specific Platform Alphas.





Customer Area of Concern

Focuses on business justification, financial management, and organizational alignment.

Alphas & States:

- Opportunity (Reused from SE Kernel): The foundational business drivers dictating the platform transformation.
    - Initiated: The desire to adopt a platform is identified.
    - Determined: The value and parameters of the platform are quantified.
    - Value Established: The platform's value is accepted by sponsors.
    - Viable: The platform adoption is deemed feasible and cost-effective.
    - Addressed: The platform provides the intended operational capabilities.
    - Benefit Accrued: Return on investment from the platform is realized.
- Stakeholders (Reused from SE Kernel): The people orchestrating and affected by the platform.
    - Recognized: All key stakeholder groups are identified.
    - Represented: Representatives for platform consumers and business units are appointed.
    - Involved: Representatives actively participate in platform design.
    - In Agreement: Stakeholders agree on platform capabilities and constraints.

    - Satisfied for Deployment: Stakeholders accept the initial platform foundation.
    - Satisfied in Use: Stakeholders successfully use the platform for operations.
- Platform Value and Economics (New): The realization of financial and strategic return on investment.
    - Identified: The potential financial benefits and total cost of ownership comparisons are drafted.
    - Modeled: A comprehensive financial model for on-demand resource consumption is created.
    - Allocated: Budgets are assigned to specific resource groups and tracking tags are enforced.
    - Optimized: Platform resources are actively rightsized, and financial waste is systematically eliminated.
    - Sustained: Cost optimization operates as a continuous, automated background process tied to business value.

Kernel Activity Spaces:

- Understand Platform Opportunity: Defines the overarching platform strategy and aligns executive sponsorship. (Contributes to Opportunity and Platform Value and Economics).
- Optimize Platform Value: The continuous process of forecasting costs and maximizing the financial efficiency of the platform. (Contributes to Platform Value and Economics).

Kernel Competency:

- Platform Strategic Alignment: The ability to synthesize business goals, organizational dynamics, and transformation objectives to define a cohesive platform adoption strategy.

Solution Area of Concern

Encapsulates the design, provisioning, optimization, and the hosted items running on the platform foundation.

Alphas & States:

- Platform (New): The foundational environment serving as the scalable backbone for operations.
    - Envisioned: Target architecture style and deployment archetypes are selected.
    - Baselined: Core platform foundation and shared environments (billing, identity, networks) are defined.
    - Provisioned: Infrastructure as Code templates have successfully deployed the baseline environment.

    - Well-Architected: The architecture is formally assessed for security, reliability, and scale; trade-offs are accepted.
    - Evolving: The architecture autonomously adapts using predictive scaling and dynamic routing.
- Platform Consumption Interface (New): The unified boundary abstracting platform complexity for consumers.
    - Scoped: Diverse consumer personas and their required capabilities are identified.
    - Unified: A cohesive consumption strategy is established via APIs, CLIs, or portals.
    - Self-Service: Consumers can autonomously provision approved architectural templates.
    - Governed: The interface automatically enforces security, cost, and compliance rules natively.
    - Optimized: The interface dynamically adapts based on deep user telemetry and continuous feedback.
- Platform Asset (New): The abstract items (e.g., containers, Lambda functions, AI models, digital services, automations, VMs) hosted by and operationally dependent upon the platform.
    - Identified: The need for the asset to be hosted on the platform is recognized.
    - Integrated: The asset is configured to natively consume platform-provided services (e.g., identity, routing, logging).
    - Operational: The asset is deployed and actively running on the platform infrastructure.
    - Value Yielding: The asset successfully leverages platform scale and reliability to deliver continuous business value.
    - Optimized: The asset's footprint and consumption of platform resources are highly efficient and resilient.
    - Retired: The asset is safely decoupled, deprecated, and removed from the platform.

Kernel Activity Spaces:

- Architect Platform Foundation: Designing the core network topology, identity perimeters, and shared services required to host workloads safely. (Contributes to Platform).
- Engineer Platform Interfaces: Building the APIs or Internal Developer Portals (IDPs) allowing self-service. (Contributes to Platform Consumption Interface).
- Host and Operate Assets: The continuous lifecycle management of diverse items running on the platform. (Targets: Platform Asset).

Kernel Competency:

- Architecture & Engineering: The ability to design distributed systems, author Infrastructure as Code, and engineer scalable, decoupled platform foundations.

Endeavor Area of Concern

Governs the execution of the transformation, encompassing people, processes, and policies.

Alphas & States:

- Team (Reused from SE Kernel): The individuals engaged in platform engineering.
  - Seeded: Core platform engineers are identified.
  - Formed: The platform team is assembled with defined responsibilities.
  - Collaborating: The team works cohesively to build platform capabilities.
  - Performing: The team consistently delivers highly reliable platform services.
  - Adjourned: The team is disbanded or restructured as the platform matures.
- Way of Working (Reused from SE Kernel): The operating model and practices utilized.
  - Principles Established: The core principles for platform engineering are agreed upon.
  - Foundation Established: Key practices and toolchains are selected.
  - In Use: The platform team actively uses the established practices.
  - In Place: The practices are standard across all interacting teams.
  - Working Well: The operating model naturally supports low cognitive load and fast flow.
  - Retired: The way of working is replaced by a new paradigm.
- Platform Engineering Work (Adapted from SE Kernel 'Work'): The effort required to build and maintain the internal platform.
  - Initiated: The need for a specific platform capability is identified.
  - Prepared: The capability is scoped, and the X-as-a-Service boundary is established.
  - Started: Engineering effort on the capability begins.
  - Under Control: Delivery metrics and user satisfaction are actively monitored.
  - Concluded: The capability is fully operational as an abstracted service.
  - Closed: The capability is in maintenance mode or legacy systems are deprecated.
- Platform Governance (New): The automated controls, policies, and guardrails ensuring appropriate usage.
  - Scoped: Regulatory requirements and internal compliance standards are identified.

    - Documented: Policies governing provisioning and identity access are written and approved.
    - Audited: The platform is actively monitored for configuration drift.
    - Enforced: Automated guardrails physically prevent the deployment of non-compliant resources.
    - Automated: Remediation of compliance drift occurs instantaneously and autonomously.

Kernel Activity Spaces:

- Establish Platform Governance: Translating compliance requirements into executable policy code. (Contributes to Platform Governance).
- Organize Platform Engineering: Structuring the platform teams and managing backlogs. (Contributes to Platform Engineering Work).

Kernel Competencies:

- Platform Security & Compliance Enforcement: The ability to design zero-trust perimeters, manage cryptographic keys, and author compliance-as-code.
- Site Reliability & Automation: The ability to engineer observability telemetry, automate incident remediation, and manage Service Level Objectives (SLOs).